# INFOLIT MADE EASY

- ***OUTLINED NOTES ON INFORMATION LITERACY SKILLS TO MAKE LEARNING EASIER...***

- ***SAMPLE QUESTIONS TO PREPARE YOU FOR QUIZZES AND END OF SEM EXAMS***

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**BY TEAM RANSFORD**

**VALCO HALL PRESIDENCY '20**

***# Valco First...***

***# Obiara Wom...***

**SPECIFIC CRITERIA FOR COPYRIGHT PROTECTION**

- The work must be fixed in a definite medium of expression
- The work must be original and the result of the author's / creator's skill and effort
- The creator must be a citizen of the country or the work must have been published in the country before anywhere else.

**EXAMPLES OF PLAGIARISM ACTS**

- Copying a text from the internet, from a book or an article, without citing the sources and claiming ownership.
- Rewriting a text in your own words without stating your source
- Paying for an essay and presenting it as your own
- Handing in another student's work under your own name
- Copying statistics, maps, tables or charts without stating your source.

**LEGAL EXCEPTIONS TO THE COPYRIGHT LAW**

- Authors or creators may transfer their monopolistic rights to publishers for marketing purposes.
- Users / publishers have rights in the form of fair use.

**DEFINITION OF PLAGIARISM**

Plagiarism means claiming or implying original authorship of someone else's written or creative work, in whole or in part, into one's own without adequate acknowledgment.

**ALPHABETS AND THEIR MEANINGS**

A - General Works.

B - Philosophy, Psychology, Religion.

C - Auxiliary Sciences of History.

D - History: General and Old World (EH).

E-F - History: America (Western Hemisphere).

G - Geography. Maps. Anthropology. Recreation.

H - Social Sciences.

J - Political Science

K - Law (General)

L – Education

M - Music

N – Fine Art

P – Languages and Literature

Q - Science

R - Medicine

S - Agriculture

T - Technology

U – Military Science

V – Naval Science

Z – Bibliography, Library Science

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**DEFINITION OF CATALOGUING AND A CATALOGUE (DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM)**

- Cataloguing refers to the process of recording information about an item according to accepted standards. Such information includes author, title, edition, publisher, year, etc.
- However, a library catalogue or a catalogue is a list of documents in a library, whereby the entries representing the documents are arranged in a systematic order. The library catalogue carries information on where the item can be found.

**WHAT THEN IS CLASSIFICATION:** Classification is the process of grouping. It involves putting together like entities and unlike entities.

**THE TWO MAJOR SYSTEMS OF CLASSIFICATION**

- Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC) System
- Library of Congress Classification (LC) System

**EXCLUSIVE RIGHTS OF A CREATOR**

- The right to make copies
- The right to be created for the work
- The right to determine who may adapt the work to other derivative forms, such as translations, performance, financial benefit from the work and other related rights

**REASONS FOR CATALOGUING LIBRARY MATERIALS**

- To enable a library user find a book of which the title, the author or the subject is known.
- To show what a library has by a given author on a given subject in a given kind of literature.
- To assist library users in the choice of book as to its edition or as to its character.

**TOOLS FOR ORGANIZING KNOWLEDGE:** 1. Cataloguing. 2. Classification

**ACCESS POINTS**

1. Call mark.
2. Author.
3. Title.
4. Subject
5. Series
6. ISBN

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**DEFINITION OF INFORMATION AND KNOWLEDGE (DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEM)**

- Information refers to facts or data that are collected, recorded, processed and stored in a retrievable form
- However, knowledge refers to human inferences and interpretation derived from processed information

**THREE COPYRIGHT ACTS OF GHANA**

- Copyright Act 85 of 1961
- PNDC Law 110
- Copyright Act 690 of 2005

**MAIN ISSUES IN A COPYRIGHT LAW**

- Gives monopoly to authors and creators in order to stimulate intellectual and artistic creativity
- Authors and creators may transfer their monopolistic rights to publishers for marketing purposes
- Users / publics have the rights in the form of fair use

**WHAT IS COPYRIGHT**: Copyright is a legal term / concept that gives the creator of original work " exclusive rights" to control the use of his or her work for a limited time.

**CHAPTER: TWO AND THREE**

**STANDARDS OF (ACRL) ASSOCIATION OF COLLEGE AND RESEARCH LIBRARIES**

- To know
- To access
- To evaluate
- To use
- Ethical / Legal

ACRL defines information literacy as the set of skills needed to find, retrieve, analyze, and use information.

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**CHARACTERISTICS OF REFERENCE MATERIALS**

- They are meant to be consulted in the library. They usually have 'Reference Only', 'Not To Be Taken Out' or ‘Not To Be Borrowed' labels on them.
- They are mostly expensive
- They are not meant to be read from cover to cover
- They are housed in separate sections of the library such as the Reference section.
- They are revised from time to time so as to keep them abreast with recent developments.

**TYPES OF BIBLIOGRAPHIES**

- Author bibliography
- Subject bibliography
- National bibliography
- Book trade bibliography

**ENCYCLOPEDIA**

An encyclopedia is a book or numbered set of books containing authoritative summary of information about a variety of topics in the form of short essays, usually arranged alphabetically by headword or classified in some manner.

**USES OF ENCYCLOPEDIA**

- Finding facts
- Provide general background or historical information
- Teach research skills; that is, a systematic approach to gather information
- Locate explanatory material or definitions.

**EXAMPLES OF PERIODICALS**: Journals, Magazines, Reports, Newsletters, Bulletins

**WHY SHOULD STUDENTS BE INFORMATION LITERATE**

- To recognize when information is needed
- To locate where the information is
- To use the information effectively and efficiently
- To help in decision making and productivity which is beneficial to the society

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**SHORT NOTES ON THE FOLLOWING**;

**SCHOOL LIBRARY**: A school library refers to a library within a pre-tertiary institution. It is used by pupils / students and staff of a public or private school to have access to a variety of resources. It supports the various educational programs at the various levels. The collections of the school library may consist of printed works such as general reference materials and those that can be taken out like textbooks and novels. Non-printed materials may include films, audios and video recordings, computers, and CD-ROMS.

**ACADEMIC LIBRARY**: An academic library is also known to be a college or university library. Its users are the academic staff, researchers, students and administrative staff. It has a function of supporting teaching and learning and research activities of the institution. The adequacy of the academic library collections to support the curricula falls under the fundamental criteria to give accreditation for academic programmes. The collection reflects the academic programmes offered by the parent institution. These library resources include general reference books, textbooks, periodicals, newspapers, government publications in the print format and a wide range of electronic information. **The main function of the academic library is for reference and reprographic services.**

**SPECIAL LIBRARY:** It is found in government institutions, research, commercial and business organizations to provide for information needs of their staff. It enables research workers and other employees to carry out their company duties effectively. Its collections include general reference materials, relevant books and periodicals in both printed and non-printed formats. Examples of special libraries include Supreme court of Ghana Library, Animal Research Institute Library, Food Search Library, Crops Research Institute Library, Oil Palm Research Institute Library**. Special library employs Selective Dissemination of Information**.

**FUNCTIONS OF A NATIONAL LIBRARY**

- Legal deposit
- Compilation of national bibliography
- Storage of numerous valuable works and rare books
- Conducting research as a consultancy service for individuals and the nation
- Practical training for library personnel

**ADVANTAGES OF TRADITIONAL LIBRARY**

- Stable collection
- Free and universal access to the collection
- No computer expertise is required

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- Can be used without electricity
- Documents can easily be photocopied

**DISADVANTAGES OF TRADITIONAL LIBRARY**

- Centralized management of the resources
- Limited access to materials
- Slow update of collection
- Users are limited to physical location
- Content of materials are not directly linked with each other

**ADVANTAGES OF DIGITAL LIBRARIES**

- Information can be accessed at anywhere and at anytime
- Access to information is quicker because of the use of computers and a network
- Information is more easily sharedwith other digital libraries
- Allow users to directly access and use the documents information they have found

**DISADVANTAGES OF DIGITAL LIBRARIES**

- It cannot be used in the absence of electricity and inadequate bandwidth
- Job loss for traditional publishers
- It is more expensive to set up and manage
- The content of some documents may not be we screened and validated
- Difficulty of knowing and locating everything that is available and differentiating valuable from useless information if one is not computer literate

*__NOTE__: The national library ensures the bibliographic control of all books and other materials published in that particular country or about the country.

**WHAT IS SELECTIVE DISSEMINATION**: It is a customize service whereby users are updated on new publications related to their field of study or research interest.

**TYPES OF LIBRARY REFERENCE RESOURCES**:

- Directional search tools (bibliographies, indexes, abstracts)
- Source type resources (dictionary, journals, encyclopedias)

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**TYPES OF ARRANGEMENTS OF RESOURCES IN REFERENCE MATERIALS**

- Alphabetical
- Tabular (as found in maths and stats works)
- Regional (such as maps and atlases)
- Chronological
- Classified

**THE INTERNET**

**SHORT NOTES ON THE FOLLOWING;**

**INTERNET:** The internet is a global network of computer networks. It is a large computer network that has connections to a vast number of computers all around the world that links millions of businesses, government agencies, educational institutions and individuals. The internet is not centrally controlled. Thus, owners of the various parts of the networks on the internet maintain them.

**BROWSERS**: A browser refers to a software or program that is used to navigate or access the entire internet. Browsers can also be used for communication and retrieval of files on the internet. Without a browser on cannot access the internet. Text- based browsers and Graphic based browsers are the two types of browsers. Examples of graphic- based browsers are Netscape Navigator, Safari, Microsoft Internet Explorer. Examples of text-based browsers are Lynx and Mosaic

**BANDWIDTH**: This refers to the speed and amount of information that is transferred from one place to the other on the internet. It is measured in bits per second (bps). The greater the bandwidth the greater the volume of information that could be transmitted at a time and the faster it will be to move information from one place to the other.

**BASIC STEPS FOR EFFECTIVE INTERNET SEARCHING**

- Define your information need
- Choose your search terms
- Decide which search tool to use
- Find out the search tool functions
- Run your search
- Review and refine your search

**REASONS FOR EFFECTIVE INTERNET SEARCHING**

- There are huge amounts of resources online

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- The World Wide Web is not indexed or catalogued, hence there is the need to formulate a careful search

- For effective use of resources such as bandwidth, money, time, and computers.

## CRITERIA TO EVALUATE SEARCH

- **RELIABILITY**: Information taken from the internet should be examined by checking the source if it could be relied upon. This is done by examining the Website's URL if the source is from an educational institution (.edu), a government agency (.gov), a non-profit organization (.org) or a commercial enterprise (.com), etc.

- **AUTHORITY**: This is perhaps the major criterion used in evaluating information. Information are searched on the internet with some type of critical value, that is, the basis of authority with which the author speaks. Here are some possible factors considered;

The author's recognition in one's field of study, reading of the author's biographical information to check his credentials, expertise on the topic and educational background if that author is not recognized. The author's position, institutional affiliation and address is also considered.

- **CURRENCY / TIMELINESS**: This refers to the timeliness of the information. In printed documents, the date of publication is the first indicator of currency. On the internet, one can check the document date or the "last updated" date or date of copyright.

- **ACCURACY** / **COMPLETENESS**: Information for research purpose must be complete and objective with relevant supported facts. When evaluating information found on the internet, it is important to examine who is providing the information and the person's point of the view on the topic of research.

- **RELEVANCY**: Relevancy refers to how well the information provided meets one's research needs. This is determined by considering how the information provided relates to the research topic.

### INTERNET SEARCH TOOLS AND THEIR MEANINGS

- **SEARCH ENGINES**: A search engine is an information retrieval system designed to help find information found on a computer system (usually the World Wide Web). Search engines are made up of "spiders or robots " to collect information; to index this information; and create databases of websites visited which are regularly updated. They have search interface. Examples of SE includes www.google.com, www.ask.com, www.bing.com. A word or phrase called a search query can also be used in a search engine.

- **METASEARCH / MULTI-SEARCH ENGINES**: Metasearch engines query several search engines at the same time and combine their results. They generate an ordered list based on comparative ranking. Metasearch engines permit users to enter

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search query once and access several search engines simultaneously. Examples include; www.yippy.com, www.ixquick.com, www.dogpile.com ,etc.

- **WEB DIRECTORIES (SUBJECT GATEWAY OR MULTI-SUBJECT DIRECTORY)**: Subject gateway collects and organize internet resources into several categories. Each. category contains links to sub-categories that link web pages containing information on broad topics. Examples include; www.yahoo.com, www.lycos.com, etc.

**DEFINITION TO THE VARIOUS TERMS;**

- **PHISHING**: This is the act of stealing login information, often by sending emails that appear to come from a legitimate source such as a bank or a website like eBay.
- **COMPUTER VIRUS**: It is a program or code that disrupts normal functioning of a computer system when loaded onto that computer.
- **COMPUTER NETWORK**: A computer network refers to a group of computers connected to each other so that they can share information and electronic resources. Computer network connections are either by cables, wire, telephone, satellite, etc. It comprises of two to over a million computers. One or more computers act as a host and the others are called clients.
- **SERVER OR HOST**: This controls access to the resources on a network and also provides services and connections to other computers on the network.
- **DATABASE**: This refers to a collection of structured records. It is structured in a way to allow orderly retrieval for research, study or administration.
- **ACADEMIC DATABASE**: This is a universal index of periodic literature covering basic research from all fields of knowledge. They contain records with defined fields such as title, author, date, URL, etc. Examples include JSTOR, SAGE, Agora, etc.
- **INTERNET PROTOCOL**: This refers to the set of rules that help the different computer networks on the internet to communicate without conflict. The protocols also determine whether the network uses a peer - to - peer or client / server architecture. **The standard internet communication protocols are called Transmission Control Protocol (TCP) and Internet Protocol (IP)**

**ACRONYMS AND THEIR MEANING**

PSTN - Public Switched Telephone Network.

ISP - Internet Service Provider

VPN - Virtual Private Network

HTTP - Hypertext Transfer Protocol

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NCS - Network Computer System

DSL - Digital Subscriber Line

URL - Uniform Resource Locator

MOOC - Massive Open Online Course

TCP - Transmission Control Protocol

ACRL - Association of College & Research Library

WIPO - World Intellectual Property Organization

**USES OF THE INTERNET**

- Communication
- Education and Research
- Entertainment
- Online services
- E - commerce

**MISUSE OF THE INTERNET**

- Identity theft or fraud
- Spamming
- Pornography
- Computer virus threat

**INFORMATION FOUND ON THE INTERNET**

- Publications
- Online journals
- Online books
- Videos and Audios

**WAYS OF ACCESSING THE INTERNET**

- Dial - up connection - Digital subscriber Line Modem connection
- Broadband connection - Satellite Modem connection

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- Cable Modem connection - Wireless and Mobile Broadband

**TYPES OF DATABASES**

- Video databases
- Audio databases
- Numeric databases
- Mixed databases
- Bibliographic databases
- Full-text data bases
- Image databases

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# PAST QUESTIONS AND LIKELY QUESTIONS

**QUIZ QUESTIONS**

1. What is Information Literacy?
2. Give two advantages of being an information literate
3. Mention any two advantages of the school library
4. Mention any two services libraries offer.
5. Which institution acts as Ghana's main library?
6. Give any three advantages of the electronic library.
7. What is a library catalogue?
8. Mention two forms of library catalogue.
9. Give any two classification systems or schemes you have studied.
10. List three access points one can use to access information in the library.
11. Name any citation style and indicate the discipline in which it is used.
12. Mention the two major ways to access the internet.
13. State two internet search tools.
14. Give the full names of these acronyms.
    a. TCP
    b. URL
    c. WWW
    d. WAN
15. What is a browser?

**QUIZ QUESTIONS**

1. What is an abstract?
2. What is an index?
3. Give two examples of dictionaries.
4. What is a reference book?
5. List two categories of libraries.
6. List two services provided by an academic library.
7. Give two examples of print resources in the library.
8. List two characteristics of reference materials.
9. What is a digital library?
10. Which library offers ISSN or ISBN to books and journals?
11. State three reasons why library materials are catalogued.
12. Which subjects do the following alphabets represent in the Library of Congress Classification Outline?
    a. B - …….
    b. E-F …….
    c. J - ……
    d. Q - ……
    e. V - …….
13. What is plagiarism?
14. Mention any three types of broadband connection.
15. Define a browser and name any two graphic-based browsers.
16. Mention any three strategies you may use to locate information from the internet.
17. In cataloguing libraries, when do you make a case for title entry?
18. Give three misuses of the internet.
19. Protocols on the internet help the different computer networks to ……..
20. Write the meaning of the following.
    a. WAN - ……
    b. LAN - ……..

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**END OF SEM QUESTIONS**

**INSTRUCTIONS:** Answer three questions in all: one from each section.

SECTION A

1. a. State four characteristics of reference materials in libraries.
   b. List two types of bibliographies you know.
   c. What is an encyclopedia?
   d. Give four uses of encyclopedias
   e. Give four examples of periodicals

2. a. Give four reasons why students should be information literates
   b. What is Information Literacy?
   c. Write short notes on the categories of libraries

SECTION B

3. Write short notes on the following:

a. Search Engines
b. Subject Gateways/Directories
c. Meta-Search Engines
d. Academic Data bases

4. a. State any two ways thjat copyright can be avoided
b. In one sentence, state why a copyright law is necessary
c. State two legal exceptions in copyright law
d. State two 'exclusive rights" in copyright law
e. Which disciplines do the following alphabets represent in the library of congress classification scheme:
f. G…….. ii. K…….. iii. P…… iv. S…… v. Z……

SECTION C

5. Dr Celestine Fafa Garvoh and Madam Jane Ama Mensah published the results of a research they conducted in the year 2000 in a journal called "Asemka", volume 22, number 5. The research topic is "The incidence of Streetism in the Cape Coast metropolis" and it covered the pages 17 to 43 of the journal.
   a. Write a reference for this article using the APA citation style
   b. Why is it necessary to organize library materials
   c. Give two specific criteria that a work must meet to qualify for Copyright Protection

6. Three university professors, Kwesi Atta Bosomafie, Kweku Tawiah Gyankaboh and Adjoa Mankah Odasanyi edited the fifth edition of a book titled "The Erstwhile Sacage: memories of a disillusioned Gold Coaster". The book was published in the year 2010 by Asempa Publications in Cape Coast.
   a. Use the APA citation citation style to write a reference for the book
   b. What are the legal exceptions to the copyright
   c. Give three specific examples of acts that constitute plagiarism

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**I WISH YOU ALL THE BEST IN EVERY ENDEAVOUR. MAY THE GOOD LORD ORDER YOUR STEPS AND LEAD YOU IN EVERYTHING YOU.**

**REMEMBER THAT AS YOU SEEK ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE, DON'T FORGET TO SEEK EXCELLENCE FOR YOUR SOUL…**
**BUT SEEK YE FIRST THE KINGDOM OF GOD AND HIS RIGHTEOUSNESS AND ALL OTHER THINGS SHALL BE ADDED UNTO YOU (MATTHEW 6:33-34)**

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